



Troubleshooting

Facing hardware issues, wondering how to convert FAT16 to FAT32 in Windows Me, having battery troubles? We have solutions to these and other problems

Applications

+ Not so compact at Access

I have been using an Access database to keep patients' records and other information for over two years. I recently started compacting the file about once a week as it had grown to about 9 MB. Once, after clicking on Compact and Repair, the file closed down, showed 'Compacting....' in the task bar and then instead of opening again, an error message popped up saying, 'AOIndex is not an index in this table'. On clicking OK, nothing further happened. Thereafter, whenever I try to open that file, the same error message pops up.

On clicking OK, it pops up again and on clicking OK again, nothing more happens. I have been using a third-party backup software and I had backed up all my files. So I tried to open the backed-up database. But even this didn't open and showed an identical error message.

I opened a blank database and tried the Import Table feature to try and recover whatever tables, forms, queries that I could, but the same error message popped up again. Can you suggest how I could recover the data tables and the painstakingly created forms?

Ravi,

Via e-mail

R There are many reasons why the database file could have got corrupted, ranging from hard disk error to power failures during a write operation. The Compact and Repair utility does help in recovering damaged files. The Compact utility eliminates empty space that may exist in a database.

The Repair utility will try and repair the existing tables, queries and indexes that are present in the database, and will not touch forms, macros, reports, etc. Try the repair utility in the following manner and see whether it works.

Create a backup first of the database, and delete the .ldb file if it is present (the .ldb file is used to determine the records that are locked in a shared database). Close the database, and go to Tools > Database Utilities and then click Compact and

Repair Database. If you get an error message, and you are also not able to import the fields to a new database, try exporting the table to an ASCII (delimited) file. Delete any relationships associated with the table and then delete the table from the database. Then try compacting the database again and recreating the relationships.

Open the ASCII file in a text editor and check out for any junk characters or strange data and remove these data. Save the file again as an ASCII text. Re-import the text back to a newly created Access table. This should solve the problem.



Use the Compact and Repair option to rectify corrupt tables

Linux

+ Really Linux

I installed DragonLinux on my computer but am unable to run it as it says "CPU is in V86 Mode. You need pure 386/486 real mode or VCP1 server to boot Linux". I use Windows Me. Please advice.

Vijay,

Via e-mail

R While running Windows Me, it is not possible to use real-mode DOS applications, hence, it disallows your Linux Loader to load up the kernel in the memory space. Installing Win 98 will obviously solve this problem, but the easiest solution would be to create a boot floppy with the old Windows 98 boot data and the Linux loader.

You should create a batch file on the floppy that loads up your Linux kernel by using the standard commands.

Alternatively, you could add these

commands to autoexec.bat making it almost automatic.

Windows

+ Please Stand By

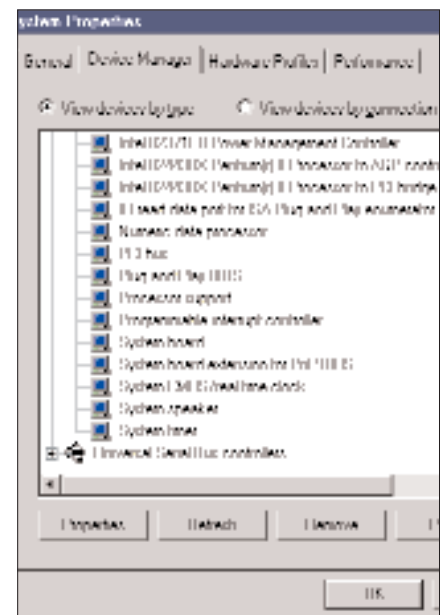
I use Windows 98 SE with IE 5.5. Recently, I wasn't able to see the Standby option in the Shut Down dialog box. The problem occurred after my computer crashed once and I had to press the reset button. How do I get back this option?

Soumitra Ghosh,

Via e-mail

R The problem is most likely due to power management issues after the computer crashed. To solve this, go to the Control Panel (Start > Settings > Control Panel) and double-click on the System option. Select the Device Manager tab, and click the + symbol next to System Devices.

If you see the Advanced Power Management item here, remove it from the list. After this restart the computer and then go to Control Panel > Add New Hardware and select Advanced Power Management (or wait for



Configuring power management